

KMVTECH EDUCATION**HRL1 · Module 8****Vulnerable groups and accountability**

Lesson: Closing the gap

Student Lesson Notes

Study with the online lessons. Prefer primary sources (Constitution, statutes, treaties, cases). © KMVTECH Education · September 2026.

1. CORE IDEA

Vulnerable and marginalised groups (women, children, persons with disabilities, minorities, refugees, persons in detention) often face structural barriers to rights enjoyment. Targeted instruments and affirmative measures address these gaps.

Accountability mechanisms include judicial remedies, the UHRC, parliamentary oversight, national preventive mechanisms against torture, and regional/international scrutiny. Non-State actors (corporations, armed groups) raise complex responsibility questions.

Closing the gap requires implementation, resources, data and political will as much as formal legal change.

- Intersectionality matters: gender, disability, age and status compound vulnerability.

2. DETAILED RULES AND APPLICATION

Example: a disability-rights claim may combine equality, accessibility duties and specific CRPD obligations; detention monitoring engages both domestic and CAT/OPCAT frameworks.

Identify the structural barrier, the specific legal duty, and the accountability forum that can compel change.

3. UGANDA / PRACTICE, METHOD AND TRAPS

Uganda has progressive constitutional and statutory frameworks for many vulnerable groups; the challenge is consistent implementation and resource allocation. Strategic litigation and advocacy remain essential.

Exam trap: treating vulnerability as a plea for charity rather than a source of specific legal duties and remedies.

Method: name the group and barrier → locate constitutional, statutory and treaty duties → select accountability route → design remedies that address both individual and structural harm.

This closing module integrates the whole course around effective protection for those most at risk.

SELF-TEST QUESTIONS

Attempt these before the platform practice quiz.

1. Name four groups that may face structural barriers.
2. What is intersectionality in rights analysis?
3. List three accountability mechanisms beyond ordinary courts.
4. Why do non-State actors complicate responsibility?
5. What makes a remedy structural rather than individual?
6. How do treaty bodies assist vulnerable-group protection?

Exam tip: Structural duties + targeted remedies + persistent accountability.

CHECKLIST BEFORE YOU LEAVE THIS LESSON

- I can state the main instrument(s) or Cap number.
- I can explain the core rule in my own words.
- I can apply the rule to a short Uganda / regional fact pattern.
- I know the common exam trap for this topic.
- I know how this lesson links to the next module.

Next step: Complete the online practice quiz for this lesson, then continue on the platform.